Newsroom

USER DOCUMENTATION · 01

Quick Start

Install Newsroom and produce a first edition

Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Quick Start · Document 01
Verified 31 October 2026

NEWSROOM · DOCUMENT 01

Quick Start

Install Newsroom and produce a first edition

Product: Newsroom 1.0.0 for Windows
Audience: A new owner or editor installing Newsroom on a Windows PC
Last verified against: `NewsroomSetup.exe` 1.0.0 and the packaged `Newsroom.exe` build of 31 October 2026

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This guide takes you from the installer to a first edition preview and a published e-paper bundle. It uses the synthetic demonstration channel that ships with the application, so you can practise the whole workflow without connecting a real Telegram account or publishing anything.

> **Important:** The demonstration channel is invented test data. It is labelled **Synthetic demonstration edition** and must not be presented as journalism. Your own publication keeps its own name, masthead and branding; the Newsroom identity belongs to the software only.

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1. Before you install

What you need

Item	Requirement
Windows	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Installer	`NewsroomSetup.exe` (version 1.0.0)
Account type	A normal user account. The installer is per-user and does not require an administrator.
Disk space	About 1 GB for the installed application, plus room for your editions, media and any local AI models
Display	A window at least 1024 × 700; the default window is 1440 × 940
Internet	Needed for the installer to fetch Microsoft Edge WebView2 if it is missing, and for optional model downloads or live Telegram access. Editing and viewing already-downloaded editions work locally.

Newsroom does **not** bundle Ollama or AI model weights. A local AI model is an optional, separate download of 2.68–6.55 GB, and it is only usable when Ollama is installed and reachable on the same PC. The fixture demonstration and PDF/e-paper workflow do not need a model.

If you already use Channel Press

Newsroom is the current name of the application formerly distributed as Channel Press. The installer recognises an existing Channel Press installation, replaces the old shortcuts and executable names, and keeps the existing data folder. Do not uninstall the old application first, and do not delete its data folder. See **Installation & Maintenance** for the upgrade details.

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2. Install Newsroom

1. Double-click `NewsroomSetup.exe`.
2. If Windows asks for permission, allow the setup to run. The installer is per-user and normally does not show an administrator prompt.
3. On the welcome page, choose **Next**.

4. Keep the default destination folder, `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`, unless you have a specific reason to change it. The folder is private to your Windows account.
5. On the shortcut page, leave **Create a desktop shortcut** selected if you want one. A Start Menu shortcut named **Newsroom** is always created.
6. Choose **Install** and wait for the files to copy. If Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime is missing, setup runs Microsoft's signed WebView2 bootstrapper. This can take a few minutes and needs an internet connection.
7. Leave **Launch Newsroom** selected and choose **Finish**.

What you should see: a single window titled **Newsroom** opens. There is no terminal window, no browser address bar and no separate worker console. If the window shows a startup error, see **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

Where the application is installed

Item	Default location
Program files	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Newsroom`
Start Menu shortcut	**Newsroom**
Desktop shortcut	Optional, if selected during setup
Your data	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress`
Published editions	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output`
Logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\logs`

`%LOCALAPPDATA%` is usually `C:\Users\<your Windows user>\AppData\Local`. You can paste the path into File Explorer's address bar.

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3. Complete first-run setup

The first time Newsroom opens, it shows **Set up Newsroom** instead of the sign-in page.

1. Leave **Owner username** as `owner`, or enter a name you will remember.
2. Enter a **Display name**, for example `Editor in Chief`. This name appears in the header and audit trail.
3. Enter a **Password** of at least 12 characters, then repeat it in **Confirm password**.
4. Leave **Create the synthetic fixture channel for the local demo** selected if you want to follow this guide exactly. Clear it if you are setting up a real publication and will import your own authorised content.
5. Choose **Create owner and continue**.

What you should see: the sign-in page with the Newsroom wordmark.

> **Keep the password safe.** There is no email-based password reset in the installed application. An owner can reset another user's password from **Users**, but losing the only owner password requires help from whoever maintains the installation.

Sign in

1. Enter the username and password you just created.
2. Choose **Sign in**.

The sign-in page warns that five failed attempts in 15 minutes trigger a temporary lockout. Wait for the lockout period to pass before trying again. Usernames are not case-sensitive; passwords are.

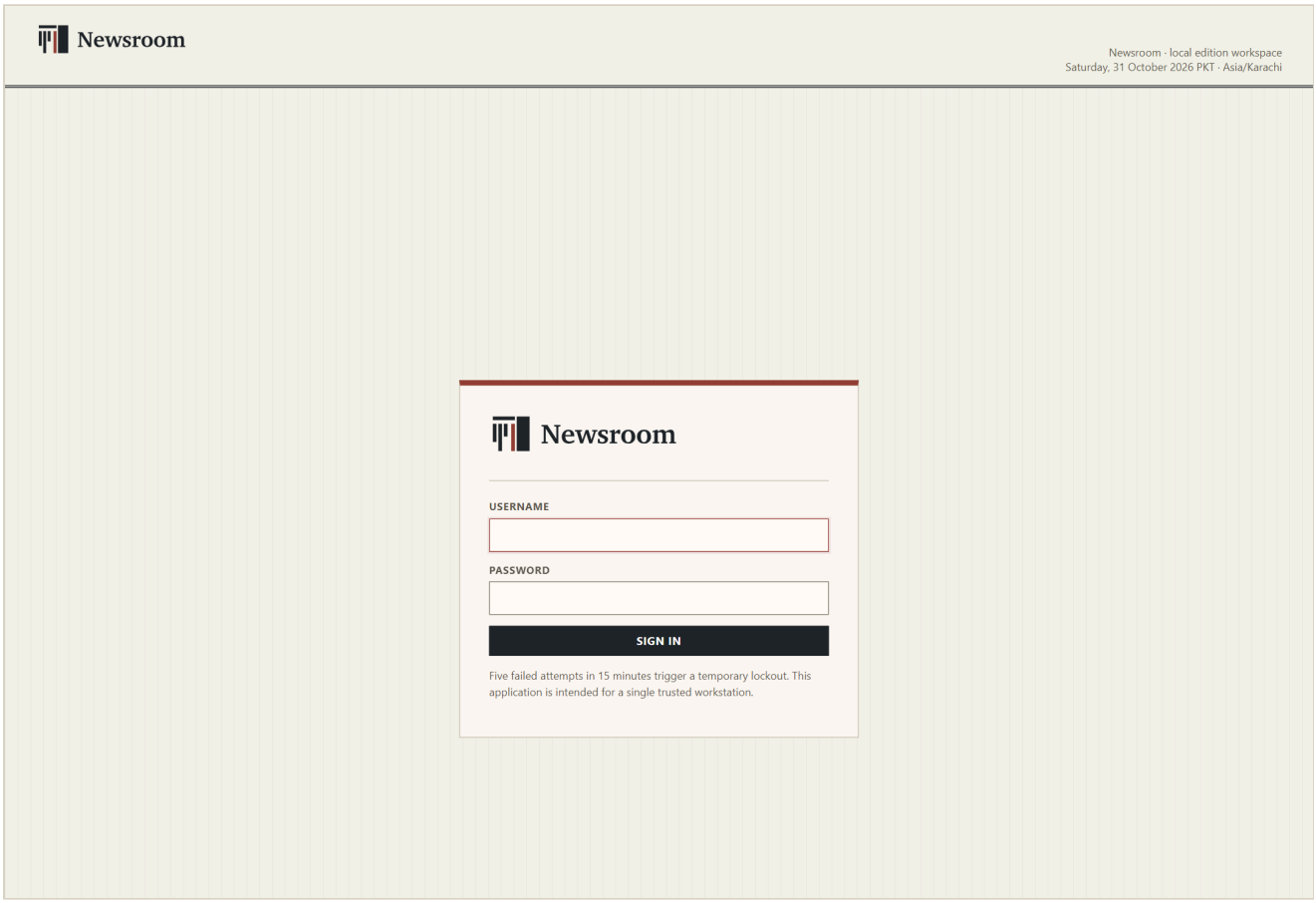


Figure 1. The Newsroom sign-in page. The application runs locally in one window.

4. Look around the workspace

After sign-in, the **Dashboard** is your starting point. The header shows:

- the **Newspaper** selector and **Switch** button;
- the current date and time zone;
- your display name and role;

- the main navigation: **Dashboard**, **Sources**, **Stories**, **Articles**, **Build**, **Editions**, **Schedules**, **Jobs**, **AI Models**, **Connections**, **Media cache**, **Branding**, **Appearance**, **Users**, **Audit** and **Diagnostics**.

Some items only appear for roles that can use them. In the tested owner account, every section was visible. The footer repeats the current publication name and the statement **Data stays on this computer.**

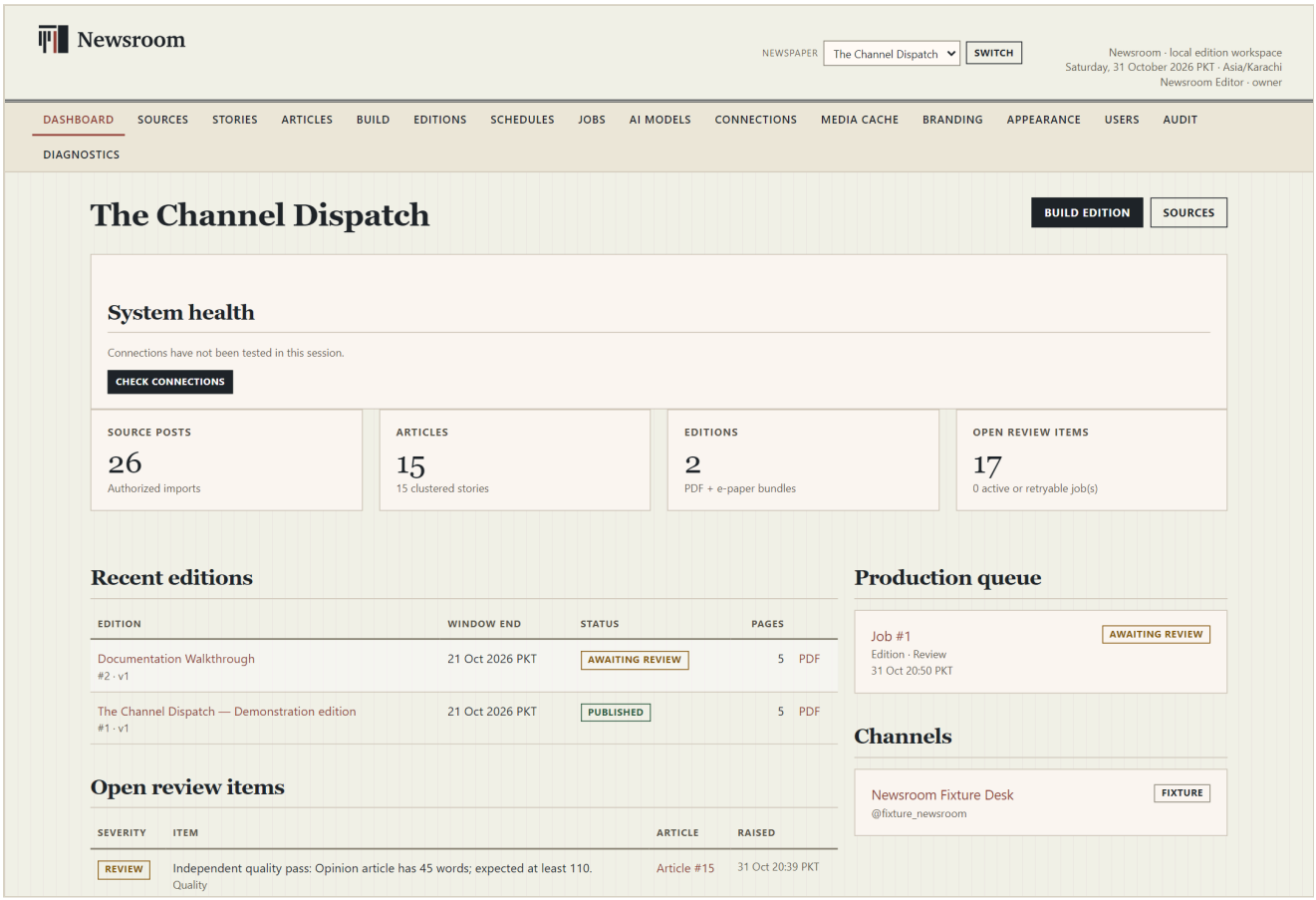


Figure 2. The Dashboard after a fixture edition has been built. The production queue shows the last job.

The Dashboard summarises:

Area	What it tells you
System health	Whether connections have been checked in this session. Choose **Check connections** to run the read-only checks.
Source posts / Articles / Editions	Counts of stored posts, clustered stories and editions.
Open review items	Editorial or quality items that still need a decision.
Recent editions	The latest editions and their status.
Production queue	Recent build jobs and their state.
Channels	Sources authorised for this newspaper.

Switch newspapers

If more than one newspaper exists, choose it in the **Newspaper** list and select **Switch**. This changes the working newspaper; it does not publish anything. Each newspaper has its own branding, sources, schedules, drafts, editions and archive.

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5. Optional: make local AI ready

You can skip this section for the fixture demonstration. The fixture composer writes deterministic drafts and does not use a model.

Newsroom does not install Ollama or download model weights by itself. To use a local Qwen3.5 model:

1. Make sure Ollama is installed and running on the same PC. Newsroom deliberately does not start an Ollama service it does not own.
2. In Newsroom, open **AI Models**.
3. Check the model cards. The three reviewed profiles are:

Profile	Model	Download	Suggested hardware
Standard · Recommended	`qwen3.5:4b-q4_K_M`	3.32 GB	6 GB VRAM / 8 GB RAM
Enhanced	`qwen3.5:9b-q4_K_M`	6.55 GB	12 GB VRAM / 16 GB RAM
Compact	`qwen3.5:2b`	2.68 GB	4 GB VRAM / 8 GB RAM

4. On the model you want, tick **I approve downloading … from the verified Ollama registry**, then choose **Verify and download**. The transfer can take a long time and uses disk space outside the Newsroom data folder.
5. When the profile shows as installed, choose **Select profile**.
6. Choose **Test local model** and wait for the synthetic test to finish.

Success check: the selected model is shown as the current model and its readiness says the local test passed. Until then, source drafting is not considered ready.

> **Hardware note:** the suggested figures are guidance, not guarantees. A 9B model on a 6 GB GPU may be slow or may not fit. Compact is a reduced-capability fallback, not an automatic replacement. AI drafts always need human review.

If **AI Models** says **Local AI runtime unavailable**, the Ollama service is not reachable. See **Troubleshooting & FAQ**.

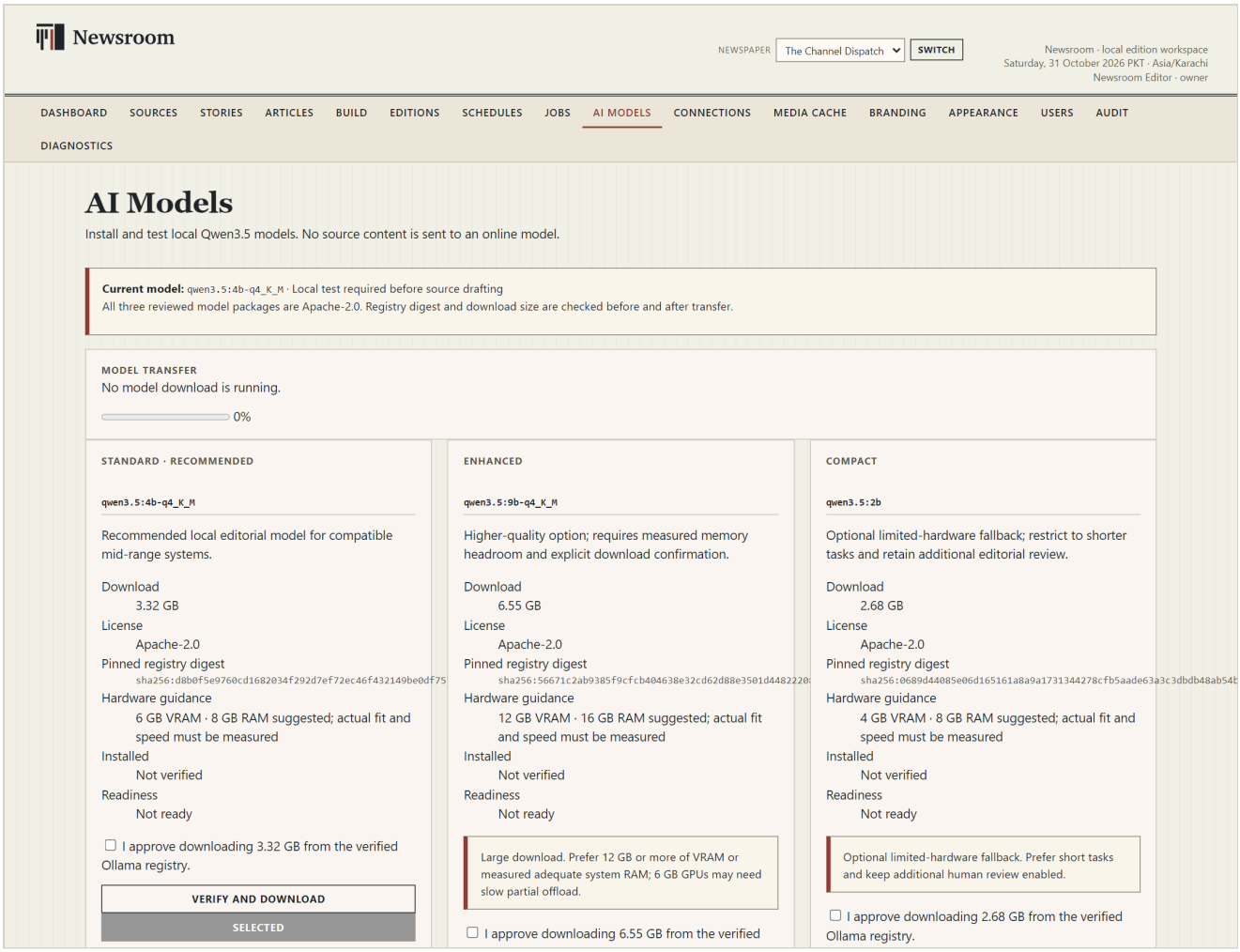


Figure 3. The AI Models page. Models are optional local downloads; the installer does not bundle them.

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6. Add an authorised source

Newsroom can work from two kinds of source:

- the **synthetic fixture desk**, which is for practice and is labelled as invented content;
- a **live import** of an export you are authorised to republish.

Public read access to a Telegram channel is **not** permission to republish it. Newsroom asks for a rights declaration before it will treat a live channel as a source.

Register a channel and record rights

1. Open **Sources**.
2. Under **Register an authorized channel**, enter:
   - **Channel title** — the name shown inside Newsroom;
   - **Internal slug** — a short local identifier;
   - **Telegram handle** — optional, for example `@channel`;
   - **Channel has a public t.me address** — tick only if that is true;

- **Grantor (person or organisation)** — who granted permission;
- **Authority basis** — for example, owner of the channel or written permission with a date;
- **Evidence reference** — where the written permission is filed. 3. Choose **Register channel**.

What you should see: the new channel appears on the **Source desk** with its rights status. A missing rights declaration is shown in red and blocks live builds.

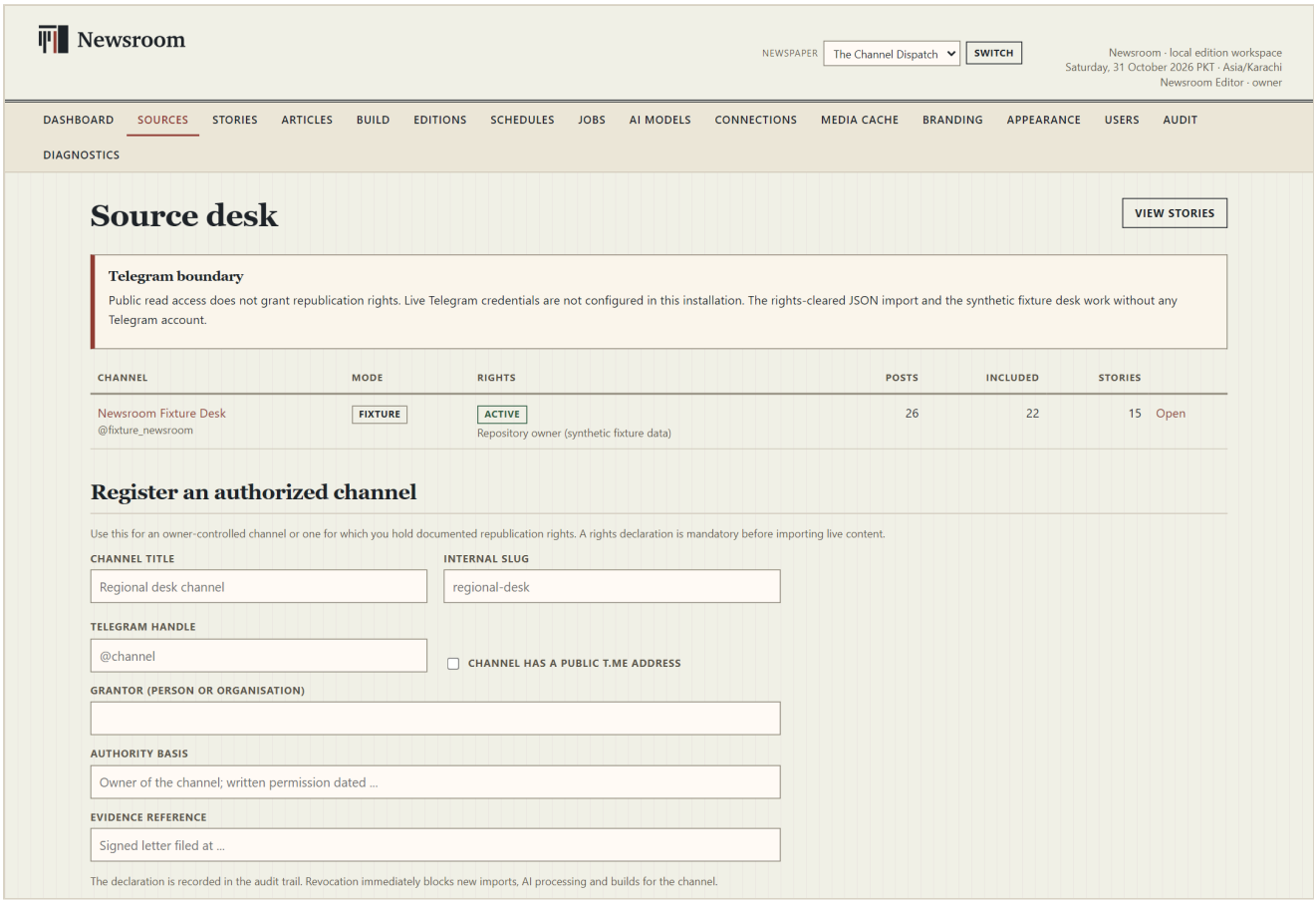


Figure 4. The Source desk. The fixture channel is an example; the registration form creates a live-import source.

Import an authorised export

1. Open the channel from the Source desk.
2. Find **Import authorized content**.
3. Choose the **JSON export** file. The owner import format and Telegram Desktop JSON export are supported, up to 40 MB.
4. Optionally choose **Referenced media files** so captions and credits stay linked to the original message.
5. Choose **Import**.

The import summary shows how many posts were read, accepted and excluded. Exclusion is normal: greetings, promotions, link-only posts, forwarded copies, empty messages and similar items are left out with a recorded reason. Open a post's **Why this classification** and use **Editor decision** if a decision is wrong.

Telegram connection

The installed build includes a **Telegram connection** page for each channel. It exposes the channel handle, **Test source connection**, phone-number sign-in, **Request login code**, **Submit code**, **Finish sign-in**, **Cancel login**, **Import last 30 days (context only)**, **Sync window**, and **Sign out**.

Live Telegram access also requires an API id/hash that the installer does not request or configure in the normal interface. If the page reports **Missing** or **API id/hash are not configured**, live collection is not available on that installation. The verified route in this build is the rights-cleared JSON import; live Telegram login and retrieval could not be verified for this documentation. Do not paste login codes or two-step passwords into chat, email or a support message.

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7. Create or adjust your publication identity

1. Open **Branding**.
2. Set at least:
   - **Publication name** — the masthead name of your newspaper;
   - **Byline (printed under every headline)**;
   - **City**;
   - **Timezone (IANA)** — for example `Asia/Karachi`;
   - **Paper size** — **Tabloid 11 × 17 in** or **A3 297 × 420 mm**;
   - **Volume number**;
   - **Source code policy** and **Public evidence-page base URL** only if you genuinely publish evidence pages. 3. Review **Section order** and the **Automatic research** policy. 4. Choose **Save publication profile**.

Success check: the newspaper name in the header and on the Dashboard changes to the name you saved. Existing published editions keep the identity they were printed with.

To create a second newspaper, use **New newspaper** at the bottom of **Branding**. Each newspaper has its own sources, schedules, drafts and archive.

> Do not put the Newsroom logo into your newspaper. The Newsroom identity identifies the software and these manuals; your publication's masthead is your own.

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8. Build your first edition

The demonstration channel already contains sample posts. This walkthrough produced an actual five-page tabloid edition from synthetic fixture data in the tested build.

1. Open **Build**.
2. Choose **Newsroom Fixture Desk (fixture)** as the **Primary source channel**.

3. The fixture window is filled from the sample posts. For a manual walkthrough, set:
    - **Window start** to the beginning of the sample day;
    - **Window end / cutoff** to the following midnight. 4. Enter an **Edition name**, for example `Documentation Walkthrough`. 5. Choose **Queue build**.

What you should see: Newsroom opens a job page with a message such as **Build queued. Worker started in the background**. The job moves through classification, normalization, clustering, drafting and layout. A fixture build typically finishes in well under a minute; a live build with media and a local model can take much longer.

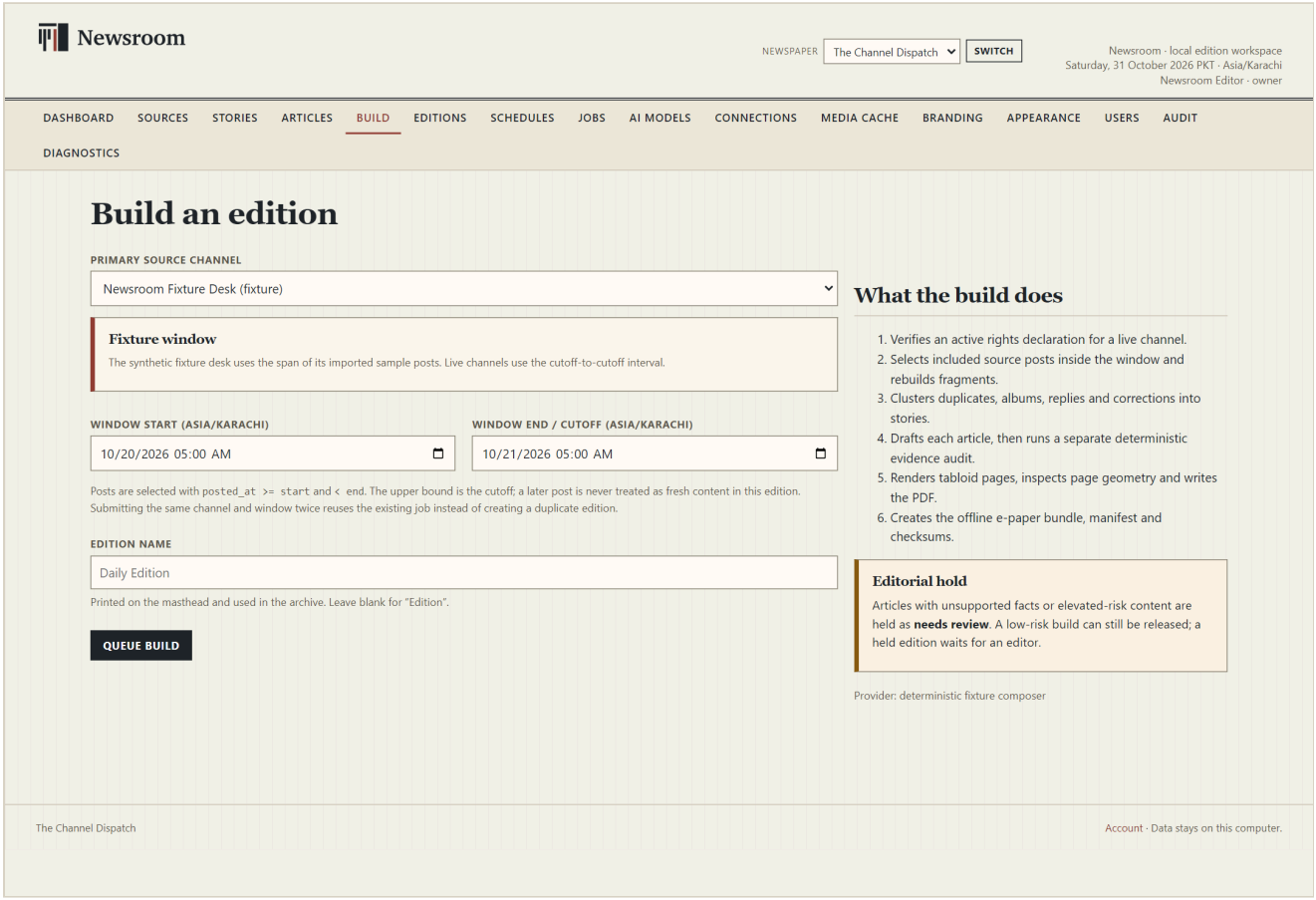


Figure 5. The Build page. The window end is the cutoff; posts at exactly that instant belong to the next issue.

Follow the job

Open **Jobs** to see queued and recent jobs. A row shows the job number, kind, channel, status, stage, progress, attempt, scheduled time, finish time and any error.

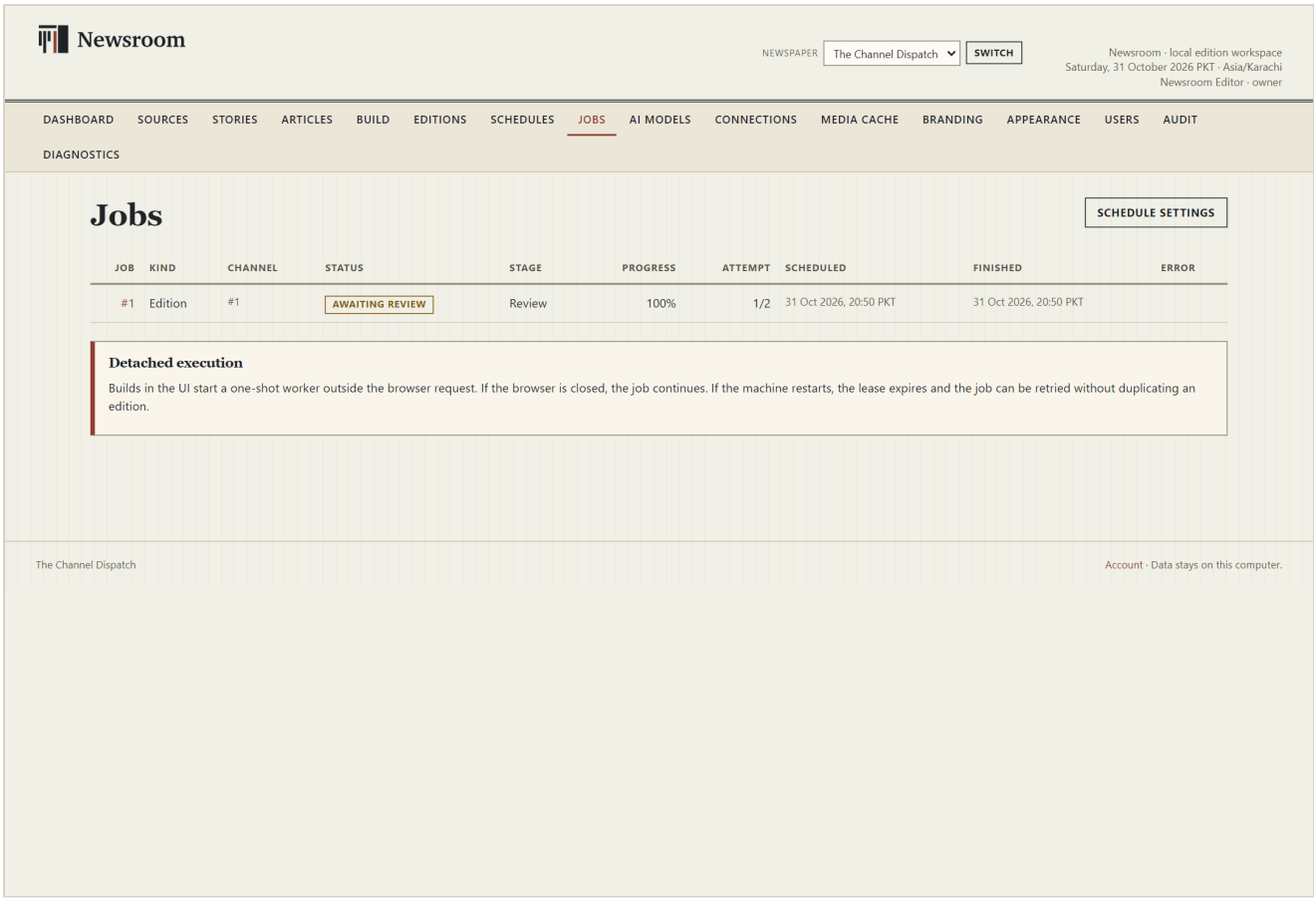


Figure 6. Jobs after a fixture build. The job finished in Awaiting review, not as a published edition.

A finished build normally ends in **Awaiting review**. That means the pages and PDF preview exist, but the edition has not been released. This is deliberate: the review step is where a person checks the copy, evidence, images and layout.

> **Do not close the window with the X while a build is running unless you choose carefully.** Closing offers **Continue in background**, **Pause safely and exit**, and **Keep open**. **Continue in background** hides the window but leaves the local service and queued work running. **Pause safely and exit** waits for safe checkpoints before stopping. See section 11.

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9. Review the edition and open the preview

1. Open **Editions**.
2. Choose the new edition. Its status is **Awaiting review**.
3. The edition workspace lists all articles on the left, the selected article in the middle and **Newspaper preview** on the right.
4. Read the **Release held** panel. It names every open review item that must be resolved before release. Typical items include an elevated-risk story, an anonymous or unverified claim, or a quality pass that finds the article shorter than its genre expects.

5. Select an article and review its **Draft text**, **Source evidence**, **Claims**, **Chronology**, **Revision history** and **Published snapshot** (for a previously published version).
6. Use **Open preview PDF** to inspect the actual rendered pages. Use **Rebuild preview only** after changing copy if the page preview is out of date.



Figure 7. An edition held for review. The preview and PDF exist, but release is blocked until the listed items are decided.

Resolve review items

For each article:

1. Open the article from the edition workspace or **Articles**.
2. Read **Draft text** and compare it with **Source evidence**.
3. In **Review items**, choose **Approve item** or **Reject item** and add a short decision note where prompted.
4. Use **Re-run independent audit** if you have changed the text and want a fresh audit.
5. Set **Article status** to **Approved** when the item is ready. **Hold**, **Needs research**, **Excluded** and **Draft** are also available.
6. Return to the edition and choose **Rebuild preview only** if the copy changed.

The exact number of items depends on the articles. A risk item is not a formality: confirm attribution, wording and whether the story should run at all.

Success check: the **Release held** panel no longer lists blockers, and **Release version 1** becomes available. If it remains disabled, open each article and resolve the remaining review items.

10. Release the edition and find the PDF and e-paper

When the edition is clean:

1. In the edition workspace, choose **Release version 1** under **Release**.
2. **What you should see:** the status becomes **Published** and an **Immutable release** badge appears. The edition and its manifest can no longer be changed.

Published files are available from the edition:

Button	What it opens
Published PDF	The frozen tabloid PDF
E-paper	The offline page-turner and text edition
Open preview PDF	The working preview, when one exists

You can also open **Editions** and use the **PDF** or **E-paper** links in the row.

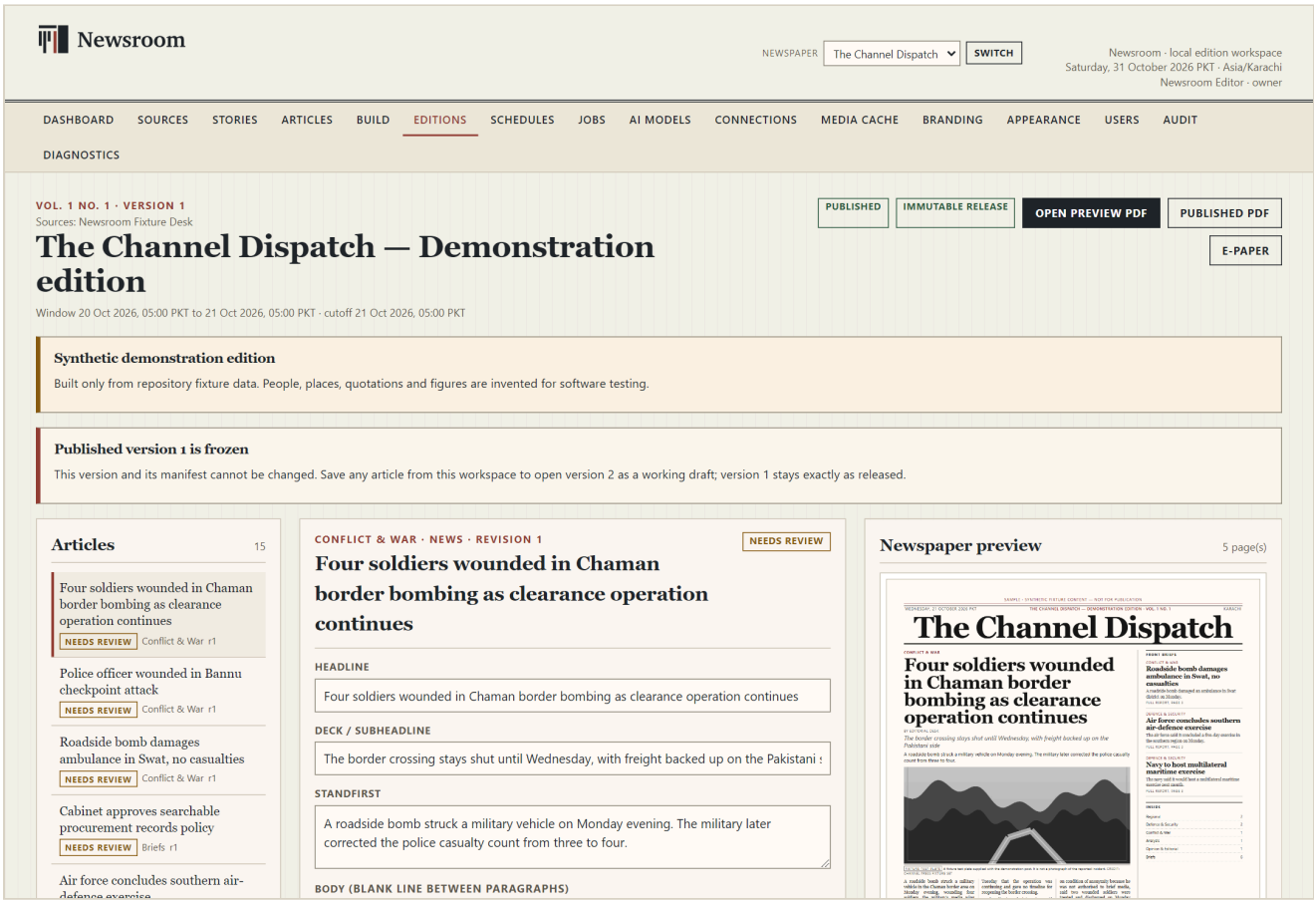


Figure 8. The edition workspace. Articles, page preview, quality summary and release controls are on one screen.

The e-paper

The e-paper is a self-contained bundle. It includes page navigation, a text edition and a source appendix. Open it from the edition's **E-paper** button. The same files are in the edition folder on disk, so the bundle can be opened without the Newsroom server.



Figure 9. The e-paper viewer for a published edition, with page navigation and a source appendix.

Where the files are

Published editions are stored under:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress\output\<publication-slug>\<edition-folder>\
```

A typical edition folder contains the PDF, page proofs, the e-paper bundle, a manifest and checksums. The exact folder name is shown in the edition's **Provenance** section. Do not rename or edit files inside a published edition folder; that would break its checksums.



SYNTHETIC FIXTURE EDITION — NOT FOR PUBLICATION. SOURCE POSTS ARE SYNTHETIC TEST DATA.

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026 PKT · MANUAL EDITION · VOL. 1 NO. 1 · KARACHI

The Channel Dispatch

A source-transparent roundup for the region · @fixture_newsroom

CONFLICT & WAR

Four soldiers wounded in Chaman border bombing as clearance operation continues

BY EDITORIAL DESK

The border crossing stays shut until Wednesday, with freight backed up on the Pakistani side

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle on Monday evening. The military later corrected the police casualty count from three to four.

FIXTURE TEST PLATE A fixture test plate supplied with the demonstration post. It is not a photograph of the reported incident. CREDIT: CHANNEL PRESS FIXTURE SET

A roadside bomb struck a military vehicle in the Chaman border area on Monday evening, wounding four soldiers, the military's media wing said, correcting an earlier police count of three.

Security forces launched a clearance operation after the blast, the provincial counterterrorism department said. The military said on Tuesday that the operation was continuing and gave no timeline for reopening the border crossing.

The district administration said the crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning. Traders said hundreds of trucks were waiting on the Pakistani side.

Two of the wounded soldiers were in stable condition at a Quetta hospital, according to the military account. A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night. That account could not be independently corroborated.

No group had claimed responsibility.

The channel initially reported that the operation had ended, then published a correction saying it was continuing.

CHRONOLOGY

20 Oct, 11:10	Security forces launched a clearance operation in the Chaman border area on Monday evening after a roadside bomb struck a military vehicle, the provincial counterterrorism department said.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 12:05	Correction published: Update: The military's media wing says four soldiers were wounded, correcting an earlier police count of three.	CORRECTED
20 Oct, 12:40	Photographs released by the department show the damaged vehicle and security personnel at the scene.	REPORTED
20 Oct, 13:20	The district administration said the border crossing would remain closed until Wednesday morning.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 14:02	A hospital official, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to brief media, said two of the wounded soldiers were treated and discharged on Monday night.	ATTRIBUTED
20 Oct, 15:15	The military's media wing confirmed on Tuesday that four soldiers were wounded in the Chaman roadside bombing and that a clearance operation was continuing.	REPORTED

Showing the first 6 of 7 dated entries. The remaining 1 are held in the edition source record and are not printed here.

Sources: A1, A2, A3, A4 and 3 more · appendix p. 5

The channel published a correction to an earlier report. This article uses the corrected figure and records the change in its source appendix.

FRONT BRIEFS

CONFLICT & WAR
Police officer wounded in Bannu checkpoint attack
Gunmen attacked a checkpoint in Bannu district on Monday, wounding one police officer, police said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

CONFLICT & WAR
Roadside bomb damages ambulance in Swat, no casualties
A roadside bomb damaged an ambulance in Swat district on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 3

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Air force concludes southern air-defence exercise
The air force said it concluded a five-day exercise in the southern region on Monday.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

DEFENCE & SECURITY
Navy to host multilateral maritime exercise
The navy said it would host a multilateral maritime exercise next month.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 2

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About this edition. This edition is an editorial roundup based primarily on authorized posts published by the owner's source channel; it is not staffed eyewitness journalism. Compiled from @fixture_newsroom by the Editorial Desk. Every factual statement is traced to a dated source message in the appendix; analysis and opinion are labelled. This is a synthetic demonstration edition built only from repository fixture data. It is not a real news report and must not be published as journalism.

MORE FROM THIS EDITION

BRIEFS
Cabinet approves searchable procurement records policy
The federal cabinet approved a national digital records policy on Tuesday, requiring ministries to...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Pakistan and Iran agree to reopen border-trade talks
Pakistan and Iran agreed to reopen talks on border trade at a meeting in Tehran, the foreign ministry said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
State Bank holds policy rate at 19.5pc as food prices persist
The State Bank held its policy rate at 19.5 percent on Monday, citing persistent inflation.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Market reopens after repairs, committee says
A local market reopened after repairs on Tuesday, the market committee said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Flood compensation portal still rejecting claims, applicants say
The provincial government's flood compensation portal is still rejecting applications from last year's...
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

BRIEFS
Border closure hurts traders, association says
The closure of the border trade route has hurt traders, a local traders' association said.
FULL REPORT, PAGE 4

Figure 10. A page from the published tabloid PDF. The newspaper uses its own masthead, not the Newsroom logo.

11. Close, reopen and keep work safe

Closing the window with the X does not simply quit. Newsroom asks what should happen to work that is still running:

Choice	Result
Continue in background	Hides the window and leaves the local service and queued work running. Launch Newsroom again to restore the existing window.

Choice	Result
Pause safely and exit	Waits for the worker and model operations to reach safe checkpoints, then closes the window and stops the local service. This can take a little time.
Keep open	Returns to the application without closing anything.

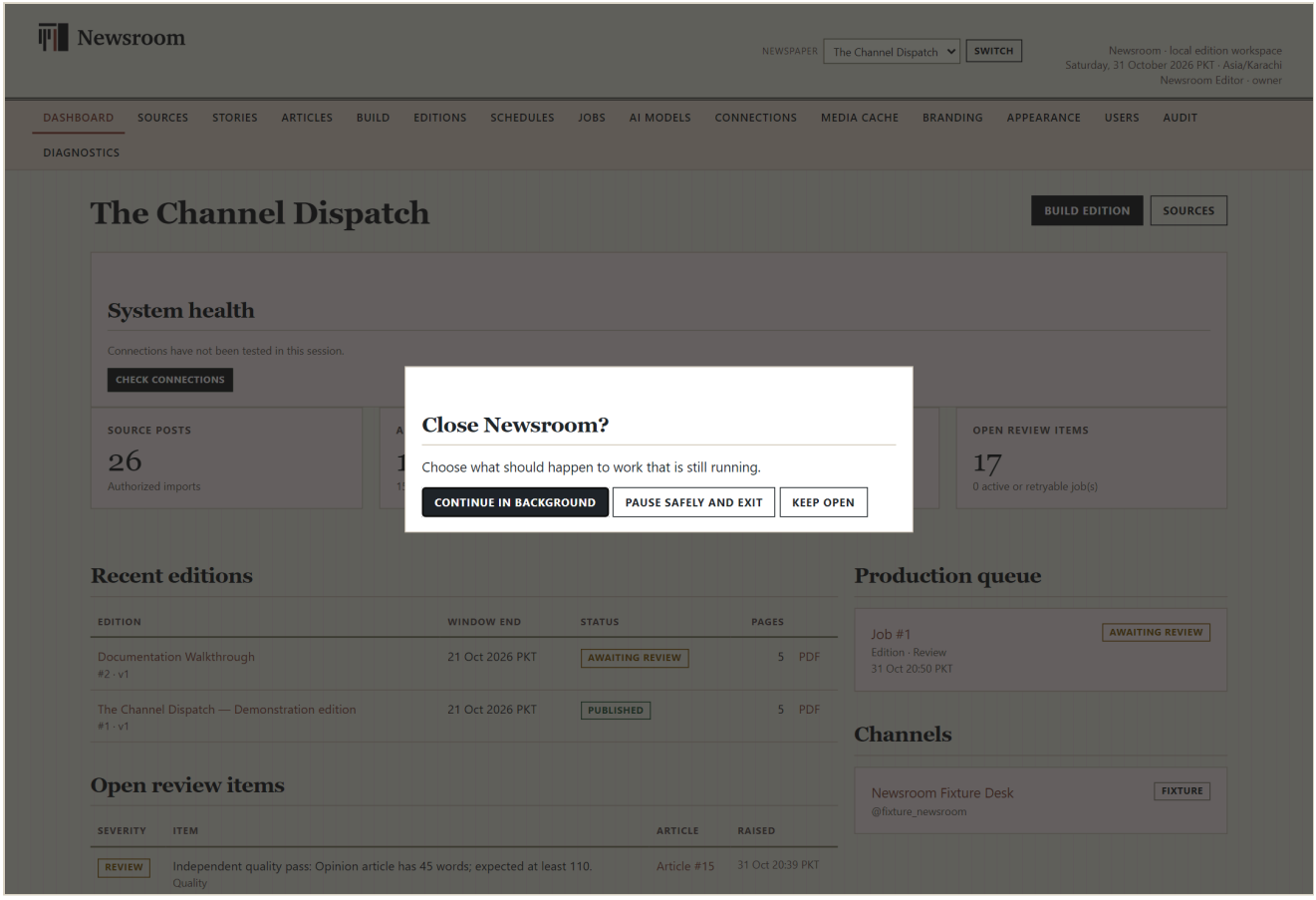


Figure 11. The close choice. "Continue in background" keeps work alive; "Pause safely and exit" stops at a checkpoint.

Only one Newsroom window can run at a time. If you launch the application again while it is in the background, Newsroom focuses the existing window rather than starting a second copy. This protects the database and the Telegram session.

Success checklist

- [ ] Newsroom opens in one **Newsroom** window with no console.
- [ ] You can sign in with your owner account.
- [ ] The Dashboard shows your newspaper and its counts.
- [ ] Your source appears in **Sources** with a rights status.
- [ ] A build reaches **Awaiting review** or **Published** without an unexplained error.
- [ ] The edition preview opens and shows real pages.
- [ ] A released edition has a **Published PDF** and an **E-paper** link.
- [ ] The e-paper opens and its pages and sources are readable.
- [ ] You know where `%LOCALAPPDATA%\ChannelPress` is and how to back it up.

If any step does not match, go to **Troubleshooting & FAQ** before deleting data or reinstalling.

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12. What this build does not do

Be aware of these limits before relying on Newsroom for a real issue:

- **No cloud account, subscription or external publishing.** Editions are released locally; there is no automatic upload to a website or social network.
- **No bundled AI.** Local models are separate Ollama downloads and may not fit your hardware. AI output is assistive and requires editorial review.
- **No guaranteed live Telegram access.** The Telegram connection page exists, but the API credentials are not set by the installer. Live login and retrieval were not verified in this documentation. The rights-cleared JSON import is the verified route.
- **No automatic unattended schedule when the app is closed.** A schedule defines the cutoff and window and can be run with **Run the latest cutoff now**; automatic background runs depend on a Windows task or another worker setup that this installer does not create. See **Installation & Maintenance**.
- **No EPUB, HTML newsletter or email export.** The verified outputs are the tabloid PDF, page proofs and the offline e-paper bundle.
- **No in-app backup button.** Back up by closing Newsroom and copying the data folder; see **Installation & Maintenance**.
- **The demonstration content is synthetic.** Never publish it as real reporting.

For the full control reference, continue with the **User Manual**. For editorial judgement and release practice, read the **Editorial & Publishing Guide**.